

Supporting Details - Workbook 02

Focused practice in choosing the strongest evidence for a stated idea. Every question tests supporting details only.

How to use this workbook

For each text, read the idea in the question first. Then choose the detail that most directly supports it. Be careful: several choices may be true, but only one gives the strongest evidence.

Text 1 - Reusable Lunch Containers

A high school cafeteria replaced disposable takeout boxes with reusable containers for one month. Students paid a small refundable deposit and returned used containers to collection bins. Cafeteria staff washed the containers in the existing dishwashing area. During the trial, purchases of disposable boxes fell by 68 percent. Staff also found that most returned containers came back within two school days. The school is now comparing washing costs with the money saved on disposable packaging.

1. Which detail best supports the idea that the trial reduced use of disposable packaging?

- A. Students paid a refundable deposit.
- B. Purchases of disposable boxes fell by 68 percent during the trial.
- C. Staff washed containers in the existing dishwashing area.
- D. Most containers came back within two school days.

2. Which detail best supports the idea that the school has not yet decided whether the system saves money?

- A. The school is still comparing washing costs with savings on disposable packaging.
- B. Students returned containers to collection bins.
- C. The cafeteria already had a dishwashing area.
- D. The trial lasted one month.

Text 2 - River Temperature Sensors

Biology students placed temperature sensors at five points along a small river. Two sensors were under dense tree cover, two were in open stretches, and one was near a bridge. On sunny afternoons, the shaded locations were consistently cooler than the open locations. The difference was largest during the hottest week of the project. The class cannot conclude that shade is the only cause of the difference because water depth and flow speed also varied, but the pattern gave students a reason to investigate tree cover more closely.

3. Which detail provides the strongest support for the idea that shade may influence river temperature?

- A. The class used five sensors.
- B. One sensor was near a bridge.
- C. The shaded locations were consistently cooler than the open locations on sunny afternoons.
- D. Water depth and flow speed also varied.

4. Which detail best supports the idea that the students are being cautious about their conclusion?

- A. The difference was largest during the hottest week.
- B. They note that water depth and flow speed also varied and could affect the result.
- C. Two sensors were under dense tree cover.
- D. The project took place along a small river.

Text 3 - New Sign-In Process

A clinic changed its front-desk sign-in process after patients reported confusion about where to wait. The old system used one paper list for every appointment type. The new system gives each patient a numbered ticket and displays the number on a screen when a staff member is ready. During the first month, front-desk staff recorded fewer questions about waiting order, and the average time spent resolving sign-in disputes dropped from nine minutes per day to two. Some patients still asked for help using the ticket machine, so the clinic added clearer instructions beside it.

5. Which detail best supports the idea that the new process reduced confusion about waiting order?

- A. The old system used one paper list.
- B. The clinic added clearer instructions beside the ticket machine.
- C. Staff recorded fewer questions about waiting order, and time spent on sign-in disputes dropped.
- D. Each patient receives a numbered ticket.

6. Which detail best supports the idea that the new process still needed improvement?

- A. Some patients still needed help using the ticket machine.
- B. The clinic uses a screen to display numbers.
- C. The old paper list covered every appointment type.
- D. The average dispute time dropped to two minutes.

Text 4 - The Window Seat

On the first day of the writing workshop, Arun sat in the farthest seat from the instructor and kept his notebook closed until everyone else had started. When the instructor asked for volunteers to read, he looked down at the table. By the third meeting, Arun had begun writing before the prompt was fully explained. At the fifth meeting, he raised his hand to read a short paragraph about his grandfather's shop. His voice was quiet, but he finished without stopping and stayed after class to ask about revising the ending.

7. Which detail best supports the idea that Arun becomes more willing to share his writing?

- A. He sits far from the instructor on the first day.
- B. He begins writing before the prompt is fully explained.
- C. He raises his hand to read his paragraph aloud and later asks about revising it.
- D. His paragraph is about his grandfather's shop.

8. Which detail best supports the idea that Arun is hesitant at the beginning of the workshop?

- A. He keeps his notebook closed until others begin and looks down when volunteers are requested.
- B. He stays after the fifth meeting.
- C. His voice is quiet when he reads.
- D. He writes about a family shop.

Answer key

1. **B** - The 68 percent reduction directly measures lower use of disposable boxes.
2. **A** - The ongoing cost comparison shows that the financial result has not been settled.
3. **C** - The repeated temperature difference between shaded and open locations directly supports a possible connection with shade.
4. **B** - Recognizing other variables shows that the students are not treating shade as the only proven cause.
5. **C** - The drop in questions and disputes directly measures reduced confusion about the order.
6. **A** - Patients still needing help is direct evidence that the process was not fully clear yet.
7. **C** - Volunteering to read and discussing revision directly show greater willingness to share and engage.
8. **A** - Waiting for others and avoiding eye contact when volunteers are requested directly show initial hesitation.